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Course name ITA14 - ETHICAL HACKING

CO1 - ASSIGNMENTS.

Question 24:

1. Executive Summary & Direct Answer

Yes, professional ethics require you to address and report this situation

although a cybersecurity professional's primary scope is technical, professional ethical codes universally establish that duty to public safety and consumer protection takes precedence over contractual obligations and client confidentiality. However, reporting must be handled carefully through appropriate legal and regulatory channels, not public disclosure.

2. Ethical principles & professional codes of Ethics:

1. Public interest first (ISC² & EC - owned codes of Ethics):

- * Major cybersecurity credentialing bodies state that an ethical hacker's highest priority is to protect society, the public, and the infrastructure.
- * When a client's business model intentionally defrauds or harms consumers, facilitating their technical security inadvertently enables and protects illegal activity.

2. The conflict of NDA vs. Illegal Activity:

- * Non-Disclosure Agreements generally do not legally bind an individual to conceal criminal activity. Contract law in most jurisdictions holds that contracts designed to facilitate or cover up crime are unenforceable.

3. To whom should it be reported?

Recipient / Authority	Role & purpose.
independent legal counsel	consult a lawyer before taking external action to protect yourself from liability and ensure whistleblower protection compliance.
Law Enforcement / Cybercrime Divisions	Local or national law enforcement agencies handling financial fraud, cybercrime or white-collar crimes.
Regulatory & consumer protection Agencies	Government regulatory authorities (e.g., Federal Trade Commission [FTC], Consumer protection Bureaus, or national financial regulators).

4. Recommended step-by-step Action Plan.

1. Pause testing: stop active social or penetration testing; immediately to avoid facilitating fraudulent operations.
2. Document Findings: securely retain evidence gathered during social that points to the scam.
3. seek legal advice: consult an independent attorney to understand your local whistleblower protections and legal liabilities.
4. Report to Authorities: File a confidential report with the relevant law enforcement or regulatory agency.
5. Terminate contract: Formally end the engagement under legal guidance, citing ethical and compliance grounds.